

ever. As a result, most Macs have integrated GPUs. Most Macs use Intel processors and come with Intel's integrated GPUs: Intel HD and Intel Iris. Most of us know that is never enough to run games smoothly. However, the newer integrated GPUs, namely the Intel Iris Pro, seems to give much better performance than the Intel HD lineup. The models with the Iris Pro cost more too (obviously).



The new Iris Pro GPUs are significantly better than previously used integrated GPUs

Then there are Macs with discrete GPUs as well. Meaning the graphics processor is separate and not integrated into the CPU. Macs' lineup of discrete GPUs consists of only AMD cards as of now and the higher-end Macs can handle recent games quite decently to a limit.

In a test run by Ars Technica recently, they ran an fps comparison for WoW (World of Warcraft) on a Mac under three circumstances. One was on a Mac running OpenGL, one on a Mac with Metal 2 and finally a Mac running Windows via Boot Camp (i.e Direct3D). While OpenGL showed an average fps of only 32, Metal averaged at 45, which was a significant improvement. However, Windows (Direct3D) outperformed both and ran far smoother than the other two at 69 frames per second. You can read the entire article here: <http://dgit.in/gamingonmac>

The screen display department is one that Apple does really well. They do have nice displays, which games could look very nice on. But those high-def retina displays will (again) need a strong GPU powering them to drive those pixels.

As of now if you're looking for a Mac that can run high-end games without much trouble, you'll only find that the most expensive of Macs have cards strong enough to run them. Be it the highest end MacBook Pro or the